

PRODUCT TEARDOWN · WALKED AS A RESELLER

The app assumes she is buying for herself.

Three individually reasonable product decisions, stacked together, quietly work against Meesho's own reseller base. This is not a list of bugs. It is a chronological account of where a real task breaks, and why each break was a defensible call on its own.

Walkthrough run 3 September 2026 · Android · account with order history · all screenshots from that session

THE PERSONA I WALKED AS

Sunita, 34

Nagpur · first year reselling
on Meesho

First year reselling on Meesho.
Runs her whole business on
WhatsApp. Does not fully trust
online payments — still prefers
COD. Buys to resell to 15–
20 regular customers in her
building and her family group.

HER JOB, THAT SESSION

Find 5 products she's
confident her customers
will reorder, and share
them to her WhatsApp
group without looking
unprofessional.

I ran the buyer app end to end as
Sunita would: sourcing for a group,
not shopping for myself. I did not go
looking for the failures below. I hit
them in the order they appear, doing
the ordinary version of her task.

Everything tagged *Verified* is visible
in a screenshot from that session
and reproduced here beside the fix
I would propose. Everything tagged
Observed is something I watched
happen but cannot prove at scale,
and I say so where it matters.

VERIFIED – SCREENSHOT

OBSERVED IN WALKTHROUGH

Session ran 3 September, one
Android device, one account
with order history. Product used
for the pricing check: **Plain Silk
Saree**, seller **KKD Creation 21**.

THE JOURNEY — FIVE CHRONOLOGICAL STEPS

The sequence is the argument.

These are not sorted by severity or grouped by theme. They are in the order Sunita hit them, because each break is made worse by the one before it — by the time the app asks whether she is a reseller, she has already made every decision it would have changed.

STEP 01 Finding five shareable products

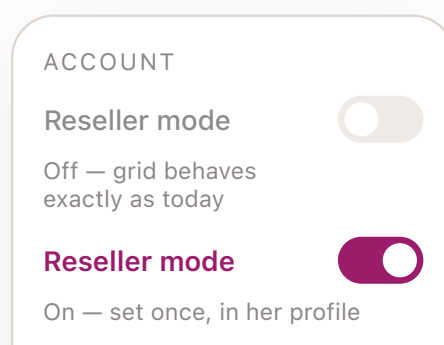
OBSERVED IN WALKTHROUGH

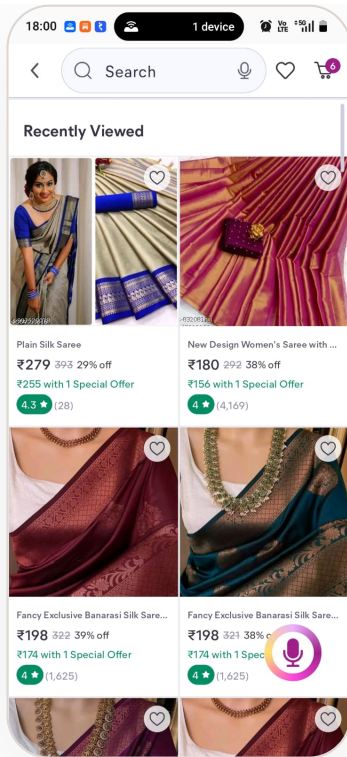
She opens the app to pick five products worth sharing tonight, before her group goes quiet.

The grid gives her price, rating and review count. It gives her no signal for what is actually selling — no resale-demand indicator, nothing showing what is moving by category or by region. She cannot tell a safe repeat-order bet from a one-time novelty item without opening each product individually and guessing from the review count.

CURRENT — FROM THE SESSION

PROPOSED — RESELLER MODE ON





Price, discount, rating. Nothing about demand, reorder rate, or region.

Sarees · Nagpur

Sorted by resale demand

MOVING FAST HERE

Plain Silk Saree
₹279

STEADY REORDERS

Banarasi Silk Saree
₹198

RISING THIS WEEK

Running Blouse Saree
₹180

ONE-TIME BUY

Festive Novelty Set
₹322

A profile-level toggle, in the spirit of Uber's Personal/Business switch. Off, the grid is unchanged. On, it reorders around resale-demand signals by category and region, so she can shortlist in minutes. Labels shown are placeholders for whichever signal Meesho already has — I am not proposing a number I cannot source.

THE STEELMAN

The grid is built for a first-time buyer's discovery, not a reseller's sourcing decision. That is a reasonable default: the majority audience is browsing for itself, and demand signals shown to everyone would read as noise, or worse, as pressure.

CRITIQUE THAT SURVIVES IT

Granting all of that, a reseller's core task is the one thing this grid gives no support for. Meesho does not have to change the default to serve her — it has to know she is her, which is exactly what it never asks until checkout.

VERDICT — ADD

Add a profile-level reseller toggle that re-ranks the grid on resale demand.
Keep the default grid untouched.

STEP 02

Trying to add more than one product

VERIFIED — SCREENSHOT

She has found the first of her five, and wants to park it and keep browsing.

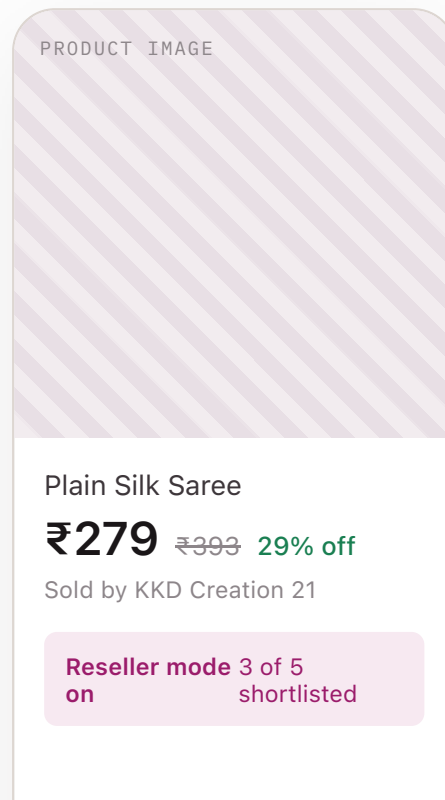
There is no Add to Cart on the product page. The only action is **Buy at ₹279**, which routes straight into checkout for that single item. To collect five products she has to enter and back out of a checkout flow five times, and the cart she does have is only reachable from the top bar, filled by a route she never intended to take.

CURRENT — FROM THE SESSION



One primary action, and it is a commitment: Buy at ₹279.

PROPOSED — RESELLER MODE ON



A screenshot of a product page (PDP) from Meesho. It shows two buttons: a white button with a purple border labeled 'Add to Cart' and a solid purple button labeled 'Buy at ₹279'.

Same toggle, second effect: Add to Cart appears alongside Buy Now, with a running count of her shortlist. Buy Now keeps its place and its weight for everyone else.

THE STEELMAN

Most Meesho buyers purchase one item at a time. Collapsing browse, decide and add into a single direct action removes a step for the majority case, and a cart that is usually empty is a cart that usually leaks.

CRITIQUE THAT SURVIVES IT

The same single-item assumption becomes a tax on anyone buying five or six items in one sitting. Every item means a detour through a checkout page she never meant to enter, and each detour is a place to lose her.

VERDICT — CHANGE

Change the PDP action pair when the toggle is on. Leave the single-action PDP as the default.

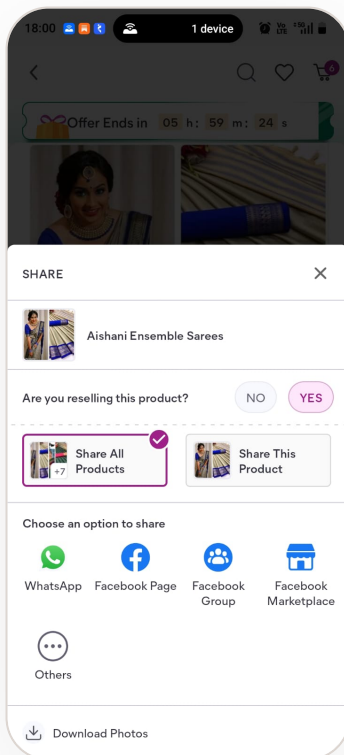
STEP 03 Reseller options appear, but too late

VERIFIED — SCREENSHOT

At the end of the flow, the app finally asks her the question that would have changed everything.

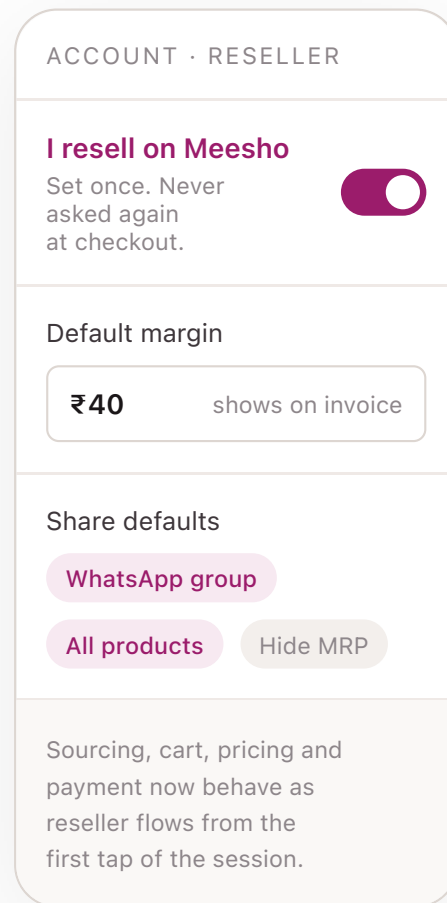
Meesho does support her. She can declare that she is reselling, add her margin so it reflects on the invoice, and share the product images straight to WhatsApp — features built deliberately for exactly her. But the question arrives at the share and checkout stage, after every product and pricing decision has already been made under the assumption she was buying for herself.

CURRENT — FROM THE SESSION



"Are you reselling this product?"
— asked at the end, per product, per share.

PROPOSED — ASKED ONCE, IN THE PROFILE



The checkout question stays as a per-order confirmation. What changes is that it stops being the only signal the app has.

THE STEELMAN

Asking in context, at the moment of the share, avoids a heavier onboarding step for the vast majority of users who will never resell anything. Onboarding questions are expensive and people answer them badly.

CRITIQUE THAT SURVIVES IT

The cost is not onboarding friction. It is that Steps 1 and 2 already happened under the wrong assumption by the time the question is asked. As a confirmation it is fine. As the app's only reseller signal, it arrives too late to act on.

VERDICT — KEEP & MOVE

Keep the checkout confirmation. Move the identity signal itself to the profile, where it can be set once and read from the first screen.

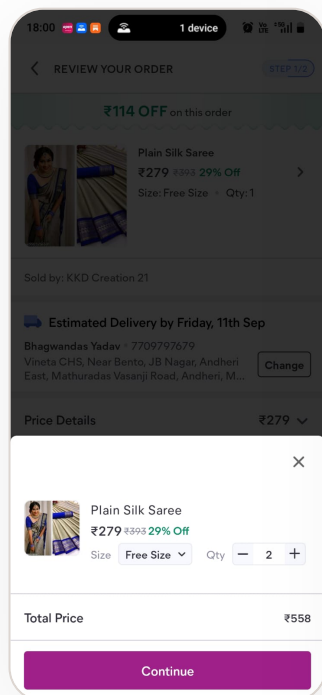
STEP 04 Adding quantity increases the price

VERIFIED – SCREENSHOT, WITH REAL NUMBERS

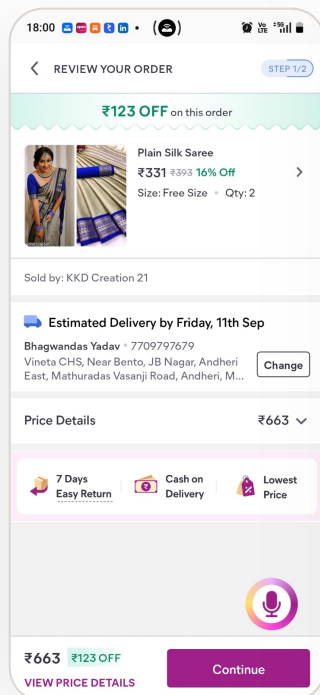
She wants two of the saree, one for a customer who already asked and one on spec.

Same product, same seller, same session. The quantity modal shows ₹279 a unit at 29% off, and a total of ₹558 for two. On the review screen at quantity 2, the unit price has become ₹331 at 16% off, and the order total is ₹663 — ₹105 more than the price she had just been shown, for the same two units.

CURRENT – FROM THE SESSION

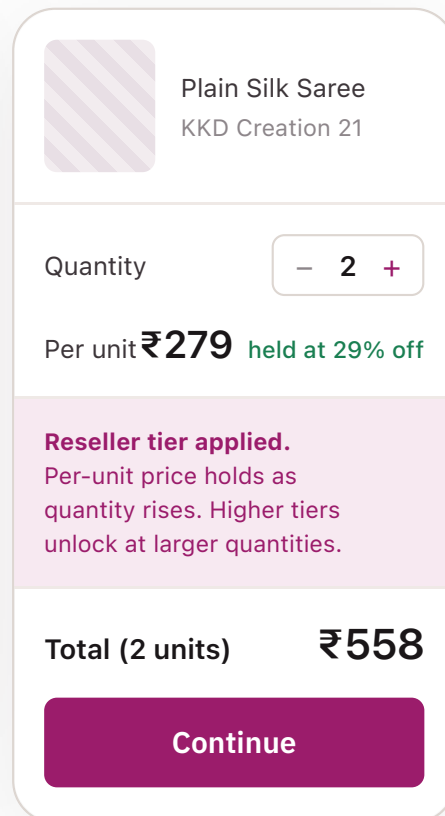


Qty modal:
₹279/unit, total ₹558



Review, qty 2:
₹331/unit, total ₹663

PROPOSED – RESELLER PRICING TIER



A separate reseller-tier curve, gated behind the toggle, that holds or rewards per-unit price as quantity rises instead of penalising it.

PLAIN SILK SAREE · KKD CREATION 21 · ONE SESSION

	Qty 1	Qty 2 — as observed	Qty 2 — if per-unit had held
Per-unit price	₹279	₹331	₹279
Discount off ₹393	29%	16%	29%
Order total	₹279	₹663	₹558
Difference	— +₹52 / unit · +₹105 / order		—

The ₹52 is arithmetic from the two screenshots above, not a description of intent. It is the only pricing claim on this page.

THE STEELMAN

Shrinking per-unit discounts at higher quantities is a normal lever against inventory and margin risk on thin-margin items. The quantity-1 price may well be a loss-leading hook for a first unit rather than a policy meant to apply at scale.

CRITIQUE THAT SURVIVES IT

Whichever way it is set, the effect on a reseller is identical: the app is economically discouraging the exact bulk-buying behaviour that defines what a reseller does. She is not gaming a hook price, she is stocking her week.

VERDICT — ADD

Add a reseller-tier pricing curve behind the toggle. Leave the consumer curve exactly as it is.

STEP 05

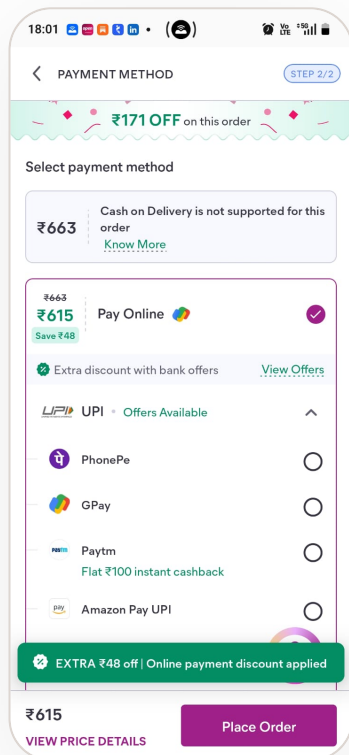
COD isn't available at payment

VERIFIED — SCREENSHOT

She has the cash in hand already. Her customer paid her yesterday.

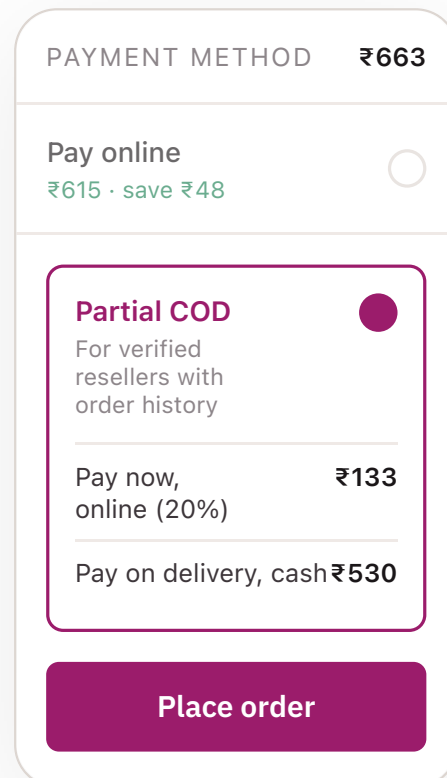
On the last screen, Cash on Delivery is not supported for this order — on an app whose own home screen advertises Cash on Delivery as one of three headline promises. The prepaid path is discounted (₹663 becomes ₹615 online), so the only route available is also the one that asks her to front the money.

CURRENT — FROM THE SESSION



COD blocked on a ₹663 order, prepaid discounted by ₹48.

PROPOSED — PARTIAL COD FOR VERIFIED RESELLERS



Roughly a fifth paid online upfront, the remainder on delivery. Meesho gets a real stake against a refused parcel; she keeps her working capital where her business needs it.

THE STEELMAN

Low-ticket orders from unproven accounts are the highest return-to-origin segment in Indian e-commerce. Blocking COD and discounting prepaid on those orders

CRITIQUE THAT SURVIVES IT

For a reseller who has already collected her customer's cash, this is not a trust problem, it is a working-capital mismatch. She is being asked to front money before Meesho even ships — and

is a rational, data-backed guardrail, and RTO cost lands on the platform and the seller, not the buyer.

unlike an anonymous first-time buyer, she has an order history the platform can price that risk against.

VERDICT — ADD

Add partial COD for verified, toggle-identified resellers with order history.
Keep the block in place everywhere else.

RECOMMENDATION

Two of the three fixes are not the toggle.

Steps 1, 2 and 3 are all the same fix seen from three angles: the app does not know who she is early enough. Steps 4 and 5 are different in kind — they are commercial policy, and they need to be named as their own decisions rather than folded into a UI change.

FROM STEP 4

Reseller-tier pricing curve

Per-unit price holds, or improves, as quantity rises.
Applied only to accounts with the toggle on, so the consumer discount curve and its hook pricing stay untouched.

Gated behind the toggle.
Not opened to every buyer.

FROM STEP 5

Partial COD

Around 20% online upfront, the balance in cash on delivery. Restricted to verified resellers with order history, which is the population whose RTO risk the platform can already estimate.

Gated behind the toggle.
Not opened to every buyer.

BUILD SEQUENCE

She hit these 1 through 5. They do not ship in that order.

The toggle has to ship first. It resolves Steps 1, 2 and 3 directly, and it is the gating signal without which the pricing tier and partial COD have no population to apply to. Shipping either of those first would mean guessing who deserves them.

1

Profile-level reseller toggle

One switch in the account screen. Re-ranks the grid, adds Add to Cart to the PDP, and carries her margin and share defaults into every order.

Resolves journey steps 1, 2 and 3. Prerequisite for everything below.

2

Reseller-tier pricing curve

Per-unit price holds as quantity rises for toggle-on accounts. Needs a seller-side policy decision, not only a pricing change in the app.

Resolves journey step 4.

3

Partial COD for verified resellers

Split tender at payment, restricted by verification and order history. Last because

Resolves journey step 5.

it carries the most risk and
depends on both steps above.

METHOD, AND WHAT I DO NOT KNOW

An earlier version of this teardown was inference. This one is a walkthrough with receipts, and the difference matters more than the conclusions.

The ₹52-per-unit shift is arithmetic off two screenshots taken minutes apart in one session, not a characterisation of Meesho's pricing strategy. It is the only number on this page I would defend in a room.

Other findings are weaker on purpose. The checkout-stage reseller options and the missing resale-demand signal are direct observations from the walkthrough — real, but not confirmed at scale, and not measured against how resellers behave in aggregate.

If I were doing this inside Meesho, the first thing I would look at is not another walkthrough. It is whether toggle-identified resellers already exist in the data under a different name, and what their basket and RTO profile looks like next to everyone else's.

OPEN QUESTION

Two sessions are enough to prove the quantity pricing pattern is real. They are not enough to know whether it is set by Meesho centrally or by the seller.

That distinction changes who owns the fix and how hard it is: a platform-level curve is a pricing-team decision, a seller-level one is a marketplace-policy and tooling problem. I am not going to guess which.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

The same quantity check across several sellers in the same category, plus one seller selling the same SKU at two price points.